



Sort by Shape

Quick facilitation notes & answer key

Goal

Children sort a mixed set of shapes into groups by one attribute (shape). Sorting/classifying is a foundational computational-thinking skill — it is how computers organize information to find it quickly.

Kindergarten frame (Ontario)

Problem Solving and Innovating — children use computational-thinking skills (sorting and classifying by attribute) to make sense of their world.

No reading is required of the child: read each prompt aloud; the child responds by drawing.

Materials

The printed worksheet + a pencil/crayon. Optional: real shape blocks or shape cut-outs to sort with hands first.

Run it (about 15 min)

1. MODEL: point to Bit's pile, say 'these are all mixed up'. Show the circle group — both ● circles together.
2. GUIDED: do the triangle group together — find each ▲ in the pile, draw it in the group box.
3. YOU TRY: children do the square group, then Exercise 3 on their own.
4. Connect: 'Computers sort too — that is how they keep things tidy and quick to find.'

Answer key (modelled by the run-gate)

Pile ● ▲ ■ ● ▲ ■ → circle group = 2, triangle group = 2, square group = 2.

Ex 1 — 2 triangles. Ex 2 — 2 squares. Ex 3 (■ ● ■) — 2 squares (the circle is left out).

Watch for & differentiate

Common slip: copying the whole pile into one group — remind them each group holds only one kind.

Simplify: sort with real objects by hand before drawing.

Extend: sort the same pile a different way (by size), or add a star ★ group.

Movement option: place shape cards on the floor and have children walk each to its group.

Success looks like

The child places every shape in the matching group and no group holds a different shape.